

TOPIC 6: MEANING AND SIGNIFICANCE OF THE VIRGIN BIRTH OF JESUS

1. Meaning of the Virgin Birth

The virgin birth means that Jesus was conceived by the Holy Spirit in the womb of the Virgin Mary, without a human father. Joseph was His legal (adoptive) father, but not His biological father. This is taught in Matthew 1:18–25 and Luke 1:26–38.

2. Doctrinal and Faith Implications

- **Jesus is fully God and fully human** – born of a woman (human) yet conceived by the Holy Spirit (divine).
- **Fulfilment of prophecy** – Isaiah 7:14; Matthew 1:22–23 (Immanuel – God with us).
- **Sinlessness of Jesus** – He did not inherit the sinful nature through an ordinary human father; He is the pure Lamb of God.
- **God's initiative in salvation** – salvation is God's work, not merely human effort.
- **Foundation of Christian faith** – the incarnation (God becoming man) is central to the gospel.

3. Lessons for Believers

Trust in God's supernatural power; accept the mystery of the incarnation by faith; recognise Jesus as the unique Son of God and Saviour.

4. Summary

The virgin birth affirms that Jesus is both divine and human, fulfils prophecy, and is essential to the Christian understanding of who Jesus is and how He saves.

End of Topic 6